

SEED POTATOES GRADING AND MARKING RULES

1. **Short title and application.**— (1) These rules may be called the Seed Potatoes Grading and Marking Rules, 1963.

(2) They shall apply to seed potatoes (*Solanum tuberosum*) produced in India and meant for export.

2. **Definitions.**—In these rules,
(a) "Agricultural Marketing Adviser" means the Agricultural Marketing Adviser to the Government of India.

(b) "Schedule" means a Schedule appended in these rules.

3. **Grade designation.**—The grade designation to indicate the quality of seed potatoes shall be as set out in column 1 of Schedule II.

4. **Definition of quality.**—The quality indicated by the grade designations shall be as set out against each grade designation in Schedule II.

5. **Grade designation marks.**—The grade designation mark shall consist of a label specifying the grade designation and bearing a design (consisting of an outline map of India with the word "AGMARK" and the figure of the rising sun, with the words "Produce of India" and ('भारतीय उत्पाद ') and resembling the one as set out in Schedule I.

6. **Method of marking.**—

- (1) The grade designation mark label shall be securely affixed to each container in a manner approved by the Agricultural Marketing Adviser.
- (2) In addition to the grade designation mark, each container shall be clearly marked with such particulars and in such manner as may be specified by the Agricultural Marketing Adviser.

- (3) An authorised packer may, after obtaining the prior approval of the Agricultural Marketing Adviser, mark his private trade mark on a container, in a manner approved by the said officer provided that the private trade mark does not represent quality or grade of seed potatoes different from that indicated by the grade designation mark affixed to the container in accordance with these rules.

7. **Method of packing.**—

- (1) Only sound, clean and dry container made of jute or any other approved material shall be used for packing. They shall be free from any insect infestation or fungus contamination and also from any undesirable smell.
- (2) The containers shall be securely closed and sealed in a manner approved by the Agricultural Marketing Adviser.
- (3) Each package shall contain seed potatoes of one trade description and one grade designation only.

8. **Special Condition of Certificate of Authorisation :-** In addition to the conditions specified in rule 4 of the General Grading and Marking Rules, 1937, the following shall be the conditions of every Certificate of Authorisation issued for the purpose of these rules, namely:

- (a) An authorised packer shall make such arrangements for testing seed potatoes as may be prescribed by the Agricultural Marketing Adviser.
- (b) An authorised packer shall provide all facilities to the Inspecting Officers duly authorised by the Agricultural Marketing Adviser, for sampling, testing and such other matters, as may be specified by the Agricultural Marketing Adviser.

SCHEDULE 1(See Rule 5)
Design for the grade designation mark

{picture as depicted on page 14 (Schedule- I)}

SCHEDULE II

(See Rules 3 and 4)

Grade designations and definition of quality of seed potatoes produced in India

Grade designation	Size min. diameter in mm.	General characteristics	Definition of quality			
			Tolerance			
			Conformity to variety	Under-size or over-size	Disease, damage etc. **	Earth and/or Extraneous matter*
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Large	25@	The tubers shall be reasonably clean, healthy viable, reasonably firm and shall have the characteristic shape, and colour of the variety. Each tuber shall have at least two sound, well developed eyes.	Tubers of varieties other than that specified on the label are permitted to the extent of 5% by count as determined on the basis of a representative sample.	A tolerance of 10% shall be allowed for accidental errors in grading in respect of tubers corresponding with the size specifications in the next lower and/or higher grade.	(1) Tubers having mechanical injury and showing signs of external damage shall not exceed 5% by count in any representative sample. (2) Superficial blemishes not affecting quality shall not exceed in aggregate an area equal to 1/4th of the total surface area on any tuber.	The presence of earth and other foreign matter shall not exceed 2% by weight
Medium	19					
Small	13					

* Where the tubers are certified by the Agriculture Department to be pedigreed and disease free, the fact would be indicated in the Grading Certificate

@Tubers which exceed 32 mm. in diameter in the case of seed potatoes raised in the plains and 52 mm. in the case of those raised in the hills shall not be permitted. In the latter case when the tubers have been passed over a riddle of greater mesh than 25 mm, the minimum size may, at the packers' discretion, be appended to the grade name, e.g., Large (size 32 mm.)

** Any disease or defect, the presence of which may be established by cutting open the tuber, shall be taken into account and potatoes having worm or slug holes penetrating into the flesh shall be regarded as a damaged.